

AI Impact Assessment (AIIA)

Template - Generic / Cross-Industry | Aligned to NIST AI RMF & ISO/IEC 42001

Document Type	AI Impact Assessment (AIIA)
Template Version	1.0
AI System Name	[System Name]
System Owner	[Role – to be completed]
Assessment Lead	[Role – to be completed]
Date of Assessment	[DD-MMM-YYYY]
Risk Classification	[CRITICAL / HIGH / MEDIUM / LOW]
Regulatory Alignment	NIST AI RMF · ISO/IEC 42001 · GDPR (where applicable)
Status	[Draft / Under Review / Approved]
Classification	Anonymised – Portfolio Use Only

This template must be completed before any AI system is approved for production deployment. All HIGH and CRITICAL systems require sign-off from the AI Governance Lead and DPO (where personal data is involved).

1. Purpose & Overview

The AI Impact Assessment (AIIA) is a structured evaluation of the potential risks, ethical implications, and organisational impacts of deploying an AI system. It ensures that decision-makers have a complete picture of the system's benefits and risks before approving deployment.

This assessment should be completed at the design/pre-deployment stage and updated whenever the system is materially changed, retrained, or redeployed in a new context.

2. System Description

System Name	[System Name]
System Purpose	[Describe what the AI system does and the problem it solves]
AI / Model Type	[e.g. LLM, NLP classifier, computer vision, recommendation engine]
Deployment Context	[Internal / External / Customer-facing]
Business Function	[e.g. HR, Finance, Operations, Customer Service]
Data Inputs	[Describe data types ingested - e.g. text, structured records, images]
Outputs / Actions	[Describe what the system outputs or triggers - e.g. summary, decision, alert]
Integration Points	[List systems, APIs, or workflows the AI connects to]
Third-Party AI Provider	[Yes / No - if Yes, name provider and confirm DPA status]
Intended Users	[Who will use or be affected by this system?]

3. Stakeholder & Impact Mapping

3.1 Affected Stakeholders

Stakeholder Group	How They Are Affected	Potential Harm	Mitigation
Employees / End Users	[Describe]	[Describe]	[Describe]
Customers / External Parties	[Describe]	[Describe]	[Describe]
Regulated Individuals (if applicable)	[Describe]	[Describe]	[Describe]
Organisation (reputational / legal)	[Describe]	[Describe]	[Describe]
Third-Party Partners	[Describe]	[Describe]	[Describe]

3.2 Benefit Assessment

Expected Benefit	Who Benefits	How It Will Be Measured
[Benefit]	[Stakeholder]	[Metric / KPI]
[Benefit]	[Stakeholder]	[Metric / KPI]
[Benefit]	[Stakeholder]	[Metric / KPI]

4. Ethical Impact Assessment

4.1 Fairness & Discrimination

Could the system produce outputs that disadvantage any group?	[Yes / No / Uncertain - describe]
Are protected characteristics present in training or input data?	[Yes / No - list if applicable]
Has a fairness/bias evaluation been conducted?	[Yes / No - describe methodology and findings]
What controls are in place to detect and mitigate bias?	[Describe controls]

4.2 Transparency & Explainability

Are AI-generated outputs clearly labelled as AI-generated?	[Yes / No / Planned]
Can the system explain its outputs in human-understandable terms?	[Yes / No / Partial]
Are affected individuals informed when AI is used?	[Yes / No / Planned - describe]
Is a model card maintained for this system?	[Yes / No / In Progress]

4.3 Human Oversight & Autonomy

Does the system make or influence decisions affecting individuals?	[Yes / No - describe scope]
Is human review required before outputs are acted upon?	[Yes / No - describe gate]
Can individuals opt out of AI processing?	[Yes / No / Not applicable - describe]
What escalation path exists if the AI produces harmful outputs?	[Describe escalation route]

4.4 Safety & Reliability

What are the primary failure modes of this system?	[List known failure modes from risk register]
What is the impact of a system error or outage?	[Describe business and user impact]
Has a formal validation exercise been completed?	[Yes / No - attach validation report if Yes]
Are all Critical and High defects resolved?	[Yes / No - list open items if No]
Is graceful degradation behaviour defined?	[Yes / No - describe]

5. Privacy & Data Protection Assessment

Complete this section for all AI systems that process, infer, or output personal data. Consult the DPO before completing.

Does this system process personal data?	[Yes / No]
What personal data is processed?	[List data types - e.g. names, emails, voice recordings]
Legal basis for processing	[e.g. Legitimate interest / Consent / Contract]
Is a DPIA required?	[Yes / No - attach if completed]
Is PII redacted before passing data to AI models?	[Yes / No / Not applicable]
Where is data stored and processed?	[Location / cloud region]
Data retention period	[Define retention and deletion schedule]
Third-party data processing agreement	[Yes / No - provider name and DPA status]
Data subject rights considerations	[How are access, rectification, and erasure requests handled?]

6. Risk Summary

Risk ID	Risk Description	Likelihood	Impact	Rating	Control / Mitigation
R-001	[Describe risk]	[H/M/L]	[H/M/L]	[CRITICAL/HIGH/MEDIUM/LOW]	[Describe control]
R-002	[Describe risk]	[H/M/L]	[H/M/L]	[CRITICAL/HIGH/MEDIUM/LOW]	[Describe control]

Risk ID	Risk Description	Likelihood	Impact	Rating	Control / Mitigation
R-003	[Describe risk]	[H/M/L]	[H/M/L]	[CRITICAL/HIGH/MEDIUM/LOW]	[Describe control]
R-004	[Describe risk]	[H/M/L]	[H/M/L]	[CRITICAL/HIGH/MEDIUM/LOW]	[Describe control]
R-005	[Describe risk]	[H/M/L]	[H/M/L]	[CRITICAL/HIGH/MEDIUM/LOW]	[Describe control]

Note: Full risk detail should be documented in the AI Risk Register. This section provides a summary view for impact assessment purposes.

7. Organisational Readiness

Are impacted teams trained to use this AI system responsibly?	[Yes / No / Planned - describe training plan]
Is there a process for collecting and acting on user feedback?	[Yes / No - describe]
Is the system included in the organisational AI inventory?	[Yes / No]
Are monitoring and alerting controls in place?	[Yes / No - describe]
Is an incident response plan in place for this system?	[Yes / No - reference document]
Have affected stakeholders been consulted?	[Yes / No - describe consultation]

8. Assessment Conclusions

8.1 Overall Assessment Outcome

Assessment Outcome	[APPROVED / APPROVED WITH CONDITIONS / NOT APPROVED]
Rationale	[Summarise key findings and basis for decision]
Conditions (if applicable)	[List any conditions that must be met before or after deployment]
Review Date	[Date for next AIIA review - recommended: annually or on material change]

8.2 Recommended Actions

#	Action	Owner	Priority	Due Date
1	[Action]	[Owner]	[H/M/L]	[Date]
2	[Action]	[Owner]	[H/M/L]	[Date]
3	[Action]	[Owner]	[H/M/L]	[Date]

9. Sign-Off

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Assessment Lead			
AI Governance Lead			
Model Owner / Product Owner			
Data Protection Officer			
Legal & Compliance			

10. Version History

Version	Date	Summary of Changes	Author
1.0	[Date]	Initial template - generic cross-industry AI Impact Assessment aligned to NIST AI RMF and ISO 42001	[Role]